
Flower Dedication

The flowers are given today by Joshua and Brittany Bryant with gratitude for our children’s ministry leaders and volunteers.

Announcements

We Rejoice with Ben & Jacy Albarracin, who were united in marriage on July 18, 2026. Please join us in thanking God for His faithfulness to them and praying He would richly bless their new life together.

You’re Invited! If your age/stage could be classified as empty-nester, senior, grandparent-era, or mature, please join us for lunch on Wednesday, July 29 at Pizza Grocery at 11:30 a.m.! Please call or email the office to let us know you’re coming.

Men’s Intensive 3 (MI3): *A Better Way to Live* — begins Thursday, August 13.

Register today! A 7-week commitment to pre-read material and show up on 7 Thursdays at 6 a.m. for 7 conversations with 7 other men you should know but may not. Open to all men in Corinth. Register at [MI3Corinth.eventbrite.com](https://mi3corinth.eventbrite.com) or scan the QR code.



Scan to register

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. Micah Monaghan

Greeters — Carson & Abbie Butler

Acolytes — Jack Windsor & Reid Butler

Ushers — Nate Alexander, Billy Scott Blackwelder, Bob Moore, Brian Thomas, & Spencer Lee

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Laura Kate Carmichiel, Sallie Kate Williams, Ashley Majors, & Brittany and Joshua Bryant

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malachi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

July 27 First Day of School (Corinth) · Back to School Prayer, 8 a.m. at the Pavilion

July 29 Luncheon at Pizza Grocery, 11:30 a.m. — empty-nesters and up

August 2 Session Meeting

August 5 Kids Quest Restarts

August 9 Deacons’ Meeting

August 10 Youth Bible Studies Restart

August 12 Wednesday Night Youth Restarts

August 13 MI3 Begins

August 14–15 Officer Spouse Retreat

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

July 26, 2026

Ninth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children’s Church — Individual members of our congregation are leading “A Word for the Children” during the month of July after the offertory. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. Children are always welcome in worship!

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Dealing with Opposition”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 4

God’s people will have seasons in life that test them. There are moments when we feel inadequate, discouraged, and completely dependent upon the Lord. In these times, there is a truth that remains crystal clear: anything that God builds will face opposition. Wherever God is building something for His glory, someone, or something, is working to discourage it, distract it, or derail it. Sometimes we assume that if we’re in the center of God’s will, life ought to become easier. Ezra tells us something different. Sometimes the greatest opposition comes precisely because we are in the center of God’s will. That’s exactly where God’s people find themselves in Ezra 4. This chapter asks a question every believer eventually has to answer: How do God’s people respond when God’s work encounters opposition?

I. We Respond with Discernment (vv. 1–5)

“The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear?” — Psalm 27:1

II. We Respond with Perseverance (vv. 6–23)

“Let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up.” — Galatians 6:9

“God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble... The Lord of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our fortress.” — Psalm 46:1, 11

III. We Respond with Confidence (v. 24)

“Wait for the Lord; be strong, and let your heart take courage; wait for the Lord!” — Psalm 27:14

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers

WORD	
A WORD FOR THE CHILDREN Children are invited to come forward as we prepare our hearts to hear God’s Word. If they brought a school backpack, they should bring it with them as well.	The Giving of Tithes and Offerings
	The Offertory “It Is Well with My Soul” (arr. Glen T. Poehlmann) Rachel Williams, Euphonium
	*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.
	A Word for the Children FPC Puppets
	The Blessing of the Backpacks Jennifer Shipp
	Scripture Reading Ezra 4 · Pew Bible, p. 391
Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8 Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field; All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.	
Sermon: “Restored by Grace: Dealing with Opposition” Rev. Waring Porter	
Prayer of Commitment	
SENDING	

CLOSING HYMN

“Be Thou My Vision” was first written as an ancient Irish prayer over 1,200 years ago. This hymn reminds us that amid opposition and uncertainty, Christ remains our true wisdom, shield, and victory.

*Hymn: #382	“Be Thou My Vision”
*Benediction	
*Postlude	

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD	
July 26, 2026 * Indicates congregation standing if able GATHERING	

The Piano Prelude	
Greetings & Announcements	
Call to Meditation: Psalm 27:14 “Wait for the Lord; be strong, and let your heart take courage; wait for the Lord!”	
The Prelude	
*Call to Worship: from Psalm 46 Leader: God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble. All: Therefore we will not fear though the earth give way, Leader: Though the mountains be moved into the heart of the sea, though its waters roar and foam, though the mountains tremble at its swelling. All: There is a river whose streams make glad the city of God, the holy habitation of the Most High. Leader: The nations rage, the kingdoms totter; he utters his voice, the earth melts. All: The Lord of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our fortress. Leader: “Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth!” All: The Lord of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our fortress.	CALL TO WORSHIP We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.

*The Hymn: #26	“A Mighty Fortress Is Our God” (vv. 1–3)	HYMN “A Mighty Fortress Is Our God” was written by Martin Luther around 1529 and is often called the Battle Hymn of the Reformation. Inspired by Psalm 46, it proclaims God’s sovereign protection and the unshakable security of God’s people.
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***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***Responsive Reading:** Psalm 27:1–4, 13–14

Leader: The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? The Lord is the stronghold of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?

All: When evildoers assail me to eat up my flesh, my adversaries and foes, it is they who stumble and fall.

Leader: Though an army encamp against me, my heart shall not fear; though war arise against me, yet I will be confident.

All: One thing have I asked of the Lord, that will I seek after: that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life, to gaze upon the beauty of the Lord and to inquire in his temple.

Leader: I believe that I shall look upon the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living!

All: Wait for the Lord; be strong, and let your heart take courage; wait for the Lord!

***Congregational Response: #26**

“A Mighty Fortress Is Our God” (v. 4)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious God, You alone are worthy of our fear, our trust, and our wholehearted obedience. Yet we confess that we have too often feared people more than You. We have sought the approval of others, remained silent when we should have spoken, and compromised where You have called us to stand firm. Forgive us for trusting in our own wisdom rather than in Your sovereign power. Strengthen our faith, renew our courage, and teach us to seek first Your kingdom, confident that Your purposes cannot be hindered. Through Jesus Christ, our faithful King and Savior, who has overcome the world, hear our prayer.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: 2 Thessalonians 3:3

“But the Lord is faithful. He will establish you and guard you against the evil one.”

***Gloria Patri**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

***Profession of Faith:** The Apostles’ Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

*that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places

PRAYER OF CONFESSION
God graciously reveals His holiness, and His people respond with humble confession, trusting His promise of forgiveness in Christ.